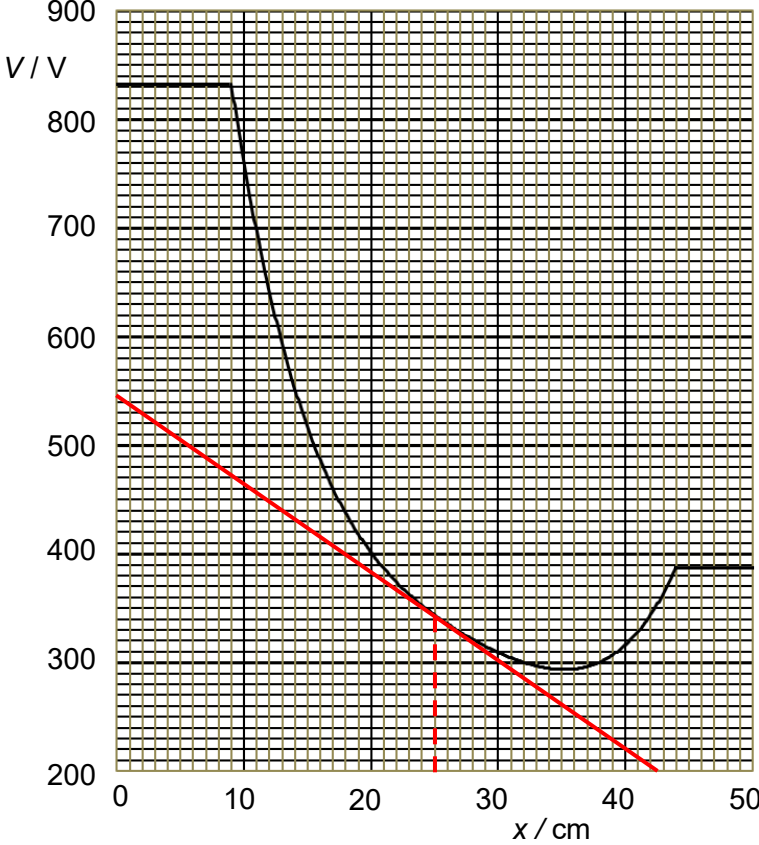


Q5	
(a)(i)	Direction of the electric field at $x = 25.0$ cm is towards the right. Electric field is always directed towards lower potential. OR Direction of the electric field at $x = 25.0$ cm is towards the right. The potential gradient is negative at this value of x as can be observed by drawing a tangent to the curve at $x = 25.0$ cm. Since E is (the negative) of the potential gradient, E takes on a positive value, which means the electric field is directed towards the right.
(a)(ii)	 Draw a tangent to the curve at $x = 25.0$ cm Potential gradient $\frac{dV}{dx} = \frac{545 - 200}{0.0 - 42.5} = -8.12$ (3 s.f.) Electric field $E = -\frac{dV}{dx} = 8.12 \text{ V cm}^{-1}$ (acceptable range: 7.3–9.7)
(a)(iii)	Mobile charge carriers within a conductor will always re-distribute until a certain equilibrium state where the electric field within it is zero. Zero electric field means that there is zero potential gradient, and hence constant potential.
(b)	The ion will accelerate to the right until $x = 35.0$ cm, then the ion will decelerate and momentarily come to rest at $x = 42.0$ cm, and accelerate back to the left and momentarily stops at $x = 25.0$ cm before accelerating to the right again, repeating the motion.

	OR	
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	The ion will oscillate between the points $x = 25.0 \text{ cm}$ and $x = 42.0 \text{ cm}$.	
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